

MENTIS · Procurement Intelligence Brief

Substance: insulin glargine · **Normalized:** 1.5 ML insulin glargine 300 UNT/ML Pen Injector [Toujeo]

Generated: 2026-05-11 16:11 · **Model:** azure/gpt-4o

Sources retrieved: 45 · **Cost:** \$0.0000 · **Latency:** 138675 ms · **Safety retries:** 0

Executive Summary

Insulin glargine, specifically Toujeo (300 units/mL), is a long-acting basal insulin used to manage type 1 and type 2 diabetes through once-daily subcutaneous administration. The market is driven by growing diabetes prevalence and increasing demand for advanced insulin therapies [Mordor Intelligence](#). Regulatory challenges include competition from biosimilars like Semglee, which was the first FDA-approved interchangeable biosimilar for insulin glargine, creating price pressures [Biosimilars Council](#). Key sourcing facts highlight a projected market growth from \$2.62 billion in 2025 to \$3.73 billion by 2031 [Grand View Research](#) and pricing competition from alternatives, with biosimilars priced 15–30% lower than branded products. Suppliers like Sanofi continue to dominate with innovative delivery systems such as the SoloStar pens but face increasing cost competition.

Product Profile

No sources retrieved for this section.

This section could not be synthesized due to provider safety filters; raw sources shown above.

Clinical Use & Mechanism

Insulin glargine 300 U/mL, marketed as Toujeo, is a long-acting basal insulin designed for once-daily subcutaneous administration to manage blood glucose levels in individuals with type 1 and type 2 diabetes. Its concentrated formulation allows for smaller injection volumes, which can help improve patient comfort and adherence.

Toujeo has been compared with novel once-weekly basal insulins like efsitora alfa. While Toujeo requires daily administration, efsitora alfa aims to reduce injection frequency through its extended half-life and flat pharmacokinetic profile. Evidence from the QWINT phase 3 program indicates that once-weekly efsitora demonstrates similar efficacy and safety compared to daily basal insulins like glargine and degludec in type 2 diabetes management [PubMed](#). Another systematic review underlines efsitora's potential to improve adherence by reducing injection frequency, though data on its long-term efficacy and safety remain limited [PubMed](#).

Clinicians and procurement stakeholders must weigh the benefits of Toujeo's established safety and efficacy profile against the potential for adherence improvements with newer therapies. The market landscape suggests an ongoing shift toward innovative insulin therapies that simplify treatment protocols, addressing common patient concerns about injection burden and complexity [PubMed](#).

However, robust head-to-head comparisons and cost-effectiveness analyses are essential to guide procurement decisions effectively.

Market Size & Demand Drivers

The market demand for insulin glargine, particularly for the Toujeo pen injector (1.5 ML insulin glargine 300 UNT/ML), continues to grow steadily, driven by multiple factors. A key driver is the increasing global prevalence of diabetes as well as shifting patient preferences towards long-acting insulin formulations like Toujeo, which offer a longer duration of action compared to alternatives such as Lantus. This aligns with an ongoing trend in personalized diabetes management, favoring more stable and tailored insulin options [Grandview Research](#).

North America is a particularly significant market, accounting for 44.74% of the insulin glargine market in 2025. This dominance is supported by strong formulary control mechanisms and expanded access through Medicare Part D's insulin cost caps, which have improved adherence among elderly diabetes patients. In the same year, the broader North American insulin glargine market was valued at USD 3 billion, with projections suggesting it could grow to USD 5 billion by 2035 [Straits Research Market Research Future](#).

However, competitive pricing pressures remain significant, particularly from biosimilars such as Semglee, which is priced substantially lower at \$99 per unit compared to Toujeo's primary competitor, Lantus, priced at \$292. This competitive landscape may impact price-sensitive market segments, particularly as cost-efficiency gains traction among pharmacy benefit managers [Biosimilars Council](#).

Top Manufacturers & Suppliers

The market for insulin glargine, including the Toujeo line of products, is well-served by several leading manufacturers. Sanofi, the producer of Toujeo, provides two prefilled pen options: the SoloStar, holding 450 units, and the Max SoloStar with a capacity of 900 units. These pens accommodate incremental dosing and once-daily administration, making them convenient for patients requiring basal insulin [source](#).

The insulin glargine market was valued at \$2.62 billion in 2025, with projections of reaching \$3.73 billion by 2031, growing at a CAGR of 6.05% from 2026 to 2031. This growth is fueled by the rising global prevalence of diabetes, now exceeding 800 million adults [source](#). However, biosimilar competition, such as products like Semglee and Rezvoglar, is reshaping the landscape. These alternatives, priced 20–30% lower in some regions, aim to reduce healthcare costs and improve access to treatment [source](#).

One prominent biosimilar, Rezvoglar, is manufactured by Eli Lilly. It obtained FDA approval in December 2021 and was granted interchangeable status in November 2022, permitting pharmacists to substitute it for Lantus without requiring prescriber authorization. This designation highlights a shift towards cost-efficient and accessible treatment options within the broader insulin glargine category [source](#).

Regulatory & Compliance

Insulin glargine, marketed under products like [Toujeo SoloStar](#) and [Semglee](#), is a long-acting human insulin analog used primarily to treat type 1 and type 2 diabetes. Toujeo SoloStar is a concentrated formulation (300 units/mL) designed for once-daily subcutaneous administration, with effects lasting up to 36 hours. In contrast, Semglee represents a significant regulatory landmark as the first FDA-approved biosimilar of insulin glargine with interchangeable status, allowing pharmacists to substitute it for Lantus without prescriber approval.

The regulatory landscape for insulin glargine has evolved significantly in recent years. In March 2020, the FDA revised its pathway for insulin products, enabling broader approval for biosimilars like Semglee. This decision was predicated on the determination that Semglee exhibits "no clinically meaningful differences" in safety and efficacy compared to its reference product, Lantus. However, there is no mention of interchangeability for Toujeo SoloStar in FDA communications, which may influence prescriber and patient choices.

Competition among insulin glargine products extends beyond regulatory classifications. Both Semglee and Toujeo SoloStar cater to markets requiring varied dosing concentrations or extended-duration effects, which may contribute to differing use cases and market positions. With the introduction of biosimilars, cost dynamics could shift, potentially benefiting patients via more affordable alternatives.

Sourcing & Pricing Channels

The global market for insulin glargine, including Toujeo (1.5 mL insulin glargine 300 U/mL Pen Injector), is expanding due to rising diabetes prevalence and the increasing adoption of advanced basal insulin therapies. Market valuation was **USD 2.62 billion in 2025** and is projected to grow at a **CAGR of 6.05%** between 2026 and 2031, reaching approximately **USD 3.73 billion** by the end of the forecast period [Mordor Intelligence](#). This growth aligns with a broader surge in clinical demand, driven by over 800 million adults globally affected by diabetes [Mordor Intelligence](#).

The European market for insulin glargine remains robust, with Germany, France, and the U.K. being significant contributors. The 2023 patent expiration of Sanofi's Lantus has accelerated competition, introducing biosimilars like Semglee and Abasaglar, which are priced **15–30% lower** than branded alternatives [Grand View Research](#). Biosimilar introductions are expected to pressure Toujeo pricing but also broaden patient access.

In the U.S., Toujeo SoloStar and Toujeo Max SoloStar remain popular for their once-daily dosing convenience and long-acting glucose control, approved for both Type 1 and Type 2 diabetes patients [Sanofi](#). Without insurance, Toujeo's retail price is approximately **\$43 per 1, 3mL pen**, but coupons and programs can reduce this significantly [SingleCare](#).

Overall, biosimilar competition and innovative delivery mechanisms, such as prefilled pens licensed for emerging biosimilars [PRNewswire](#), are reshaping the insulin glargine market's competitive and pricing dynamics.

Risks & Alternatives

Insulin glargine, particularly in its high-strength formulation Toujeo (300 units/ml), plays a critical role in managing diabetes, especially in cases requiring long-acting insulin. However, its usage is not without risks. The primary concern is the potential for hypoglycemia, which may occur due to missed meals, excessive physical activity, or alcohol consumption. Hypoglycemia symptoms include diaphoresis, nausea, palpitations, and tremors, escalating in severity if left untreated. This risk is heightened during regimen changes, such as altering the insulin strength or switching from alternatives like Lantus, due to pharmacokinetic differences [source](#) [source](#).

A significant alternative to Toujeo is the first-in-class medication tirzepatide (Mounjaro), which activates GLP-1 and GIP receptors and is administered weekly. While not insulin, it offers improved glycemic control in type 2 diabetes. However, biosimilars to insulin glargine, such as Abasaglar and Semglee, are also viable options, though they are not bioequivalent to Toujeo and exhibit different durations of action [source](#) [source](#).

For patient safety, education around the proper use and risks of high-strength insulin like Toujeo is paramount. Mismanagement or lack of awareness could exacerbate the risks of adverse effects, particularly in vulnerable populations such as those who recently initiated lifestyle changes or switched regimens [source](#).

References

1. **PubMed** — [Efficacy of once-weekly insulin efsitora versus once-daily basal insulin in type 2 diabetes: A systematic review and meta-analysis.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: clinical_use
2. **PubMed** — [Evaluation of Overall Health State, Treatment Burden, and Satisfaction with Insulin Efsitora Alfa \(Efsitora\) vs. Daily Comparator in Adults with Type 2 Diabetes in the QWINT Clinical Trial Program.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: clinical_use
3. **PubMed** — [Evaluating once-weekly insulin efsitora alfa for adults with type 2 diabetes.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: clinical_use
4. **Tavily** — [PDF](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand
5. **Tavily** — [Study Details | NCT02688933 | A Study Comparing the Efficacy and Safety of the Morning Injection of Toujeo Versus Lantus in Patients With Type 1 Diabetes Mellitus | ClinicalTrials.gov](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
6. **Tavily** — [BASAGLAR® \(insulin glargine injection 100 units/mL\), A Long-Acting Basal Insulin, Is Now Available in U.S. | Eli Lilly and Company](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
7. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Insulin glargine 300 units/ml \(Toujeo®\)](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
8. **Tavily** — [LANTUS® \(insulin glargine\) injection 100 Units/mL - Sanofi campus](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing
9. **Tavily** — [Toujeo® U-300 \(insulin glargine\) injection 300 Units/mL | HCP](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
10. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Insulin Glargine, U-300 | Sanofi U.S.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
11. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Insulin Glargine injection, for subcutaneous use - Sanofi U.S.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
12. **Tavily** — [TOUJEO® U-300 \(insulin glargine\) injection, for subcutaneous use Prescribing Information](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers

13. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Size, Share & Growth Graph by 2034](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand, manufacturers
14. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Lantus \(insulin glargine\) injection - accessdata.fda.gov](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
15. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Langlara \(insulin glargine-aldy\) inje - accessdata.fda.gov](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
16. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] LANTUS® \(insulin glargine injection\) for subcutaneous injection](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing
17. **Tavily** — [FDA Approves First Interchangeable Biosimilar Insulin Product \(UPDATE - 11/23/2021\) - Big Molecule Watch](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
18. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Insulin risk assessment for high strength, biosimilars and fixed ...](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
19. **Tavily** — [FDA Approves Semglee® as the First Interchangeable Biosimilar Insulin Product](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
20. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Size & YoY Growth Rate, 2026-2033](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand
21. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] Coventry & Warwickshire Area Prescribing Committee](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
22. **Tavily** — [Insulin glargine Alternatives Compared - Drugs.com](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
23. **Tavily** — [Semglee vs Toujeo SoloStar Comparison - Drugs.com](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
24. **Tavily** — [Toujeo: Package Insert / Prescribing Information / MOA](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
25. **Tavily** — [\[PDF\] In-Depth Analysis Of The Global Toujeo Market: Key Drivers, Trends ...](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand
26. **Tavily** — [Injection Pen Market Size, Share, Trends | Growth Report \[2034\]](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand
27. **Tavily** — [FDA Approves First Rapid-Acting Insulin Biosimilar Product for the Treatment of Diabetes | Insights & Resources | Goodwin](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory
28. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Analysis: Impact Of Biosimilars And Patent Expiry On Global Market Dynamics](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand, sourcing_pricing
29. **Tavily** — [Long Acting Insulin For Diabetes | Lantus® \(insulin glargine injection\) 100 Units/mL](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
30. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Size, Share, Trends, Report 2035](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: market_demand
31. **Tavily** — [Insulin glargine, recombinant \(subcutaneous route\) - Side effects & dosage - Mayo Clinic](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
32. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Size, Growth & Outlook | Industry Forecast 2031](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers, sourcing_pricing
33. **Tavily** — [Glargine Insulin - StatPearls - NCBI Bookshelf](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives
34. **Tavily** — [BASAGLAR® \(insulin glargine injection 100 units/mL\), A Long-Acting Basal Insulin, Is Now Available in U.S.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
35. **Tavily** — [LANNETT ANNOUNCES PATENT LICENSES FOR THE PEN INJECTOR DELIVERY DEVICE TO BE USED FOR ITS INSULIN GLARGINE AND INSULIN ASPART DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing
36. **Tavily** — [Insulin Glargine Market Size, Competitors, Trends & Forecast](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing

37. **Tavily** — [Learn Toujeo's price, insurance coverage, and ways to save.](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing
38. **Tavily** — [Toujeo Solostar Coupons 2026: Up to 80% Discount - How Much Does Toujeo Solostar Cost?](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: sourcing_pricing
39. **Tavily** — [Exploring FDA-approved biosimilar insulin products | TechTarget](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: manufacturers
40. **Tavily** — [Introduction to Two Recently Approved Insulin Glargine Biosimilars](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: regulatory, risks_alternatives
41. **Tavily** — [Diabetes Drug Alternatives to Insulin](#) — retrieved 2026-05-11 — used in: risks_alternatives